

Household Storage and Labelling Guide

A practical sorting system for every home

Includes box planning, shelf placement and printable labels

Simple rule: sort by purpose first, then by frequency.

1

**Put similar
items
together**

2

**Keep daily-use
items in front**

3

**Label every
box clearly**

Use the guide as a ready system or replace the sample items with your own household items.

1. The Standard Sorting Method

A household looks untidy when items are sorted by chance: a charger beside spices, a medicine beside a cable, a ruler inside a kitchen box. The cleaner method is to sort each item by its purpose first, and only then decide where it should be placed.

Use this simple three-step method in every room:

- Sort by purpose: writing items with writing items, medicines with medicines, tools with tools, and cables with cables.
- Sort by frequency: daily items in front or on the top shelf; weekly items in the middle; rare items at the back, bottom or in a closed box.
- Label before storing: every box should have one clear name. If the box name is vague, items will again become mixed.

Good household storage is not about buying many boxes. It is about giving every object a fixed home.

2. The Household Category System

No.	Category	Examples	Best Location
1	Daily Desk & Writing	Pens, pencils, markers, eraser, stapler, scissors, ruler, keys, glasses.	Front shelf, study table or top drawer.
2	Documents & Books	Bills, receipts, certificates, loose papers, notebooks, books.	Flat box or file box on middle shelf.
3	Kitchen & Pantry	Spice packets, small containers, pickle/condiment jar, cups and bowls.	Kitchen rack or pantry shelf.
4	Cleaning & Laundry	Detergent, fabric softener, handwash refill, cloths, wipes, tissues.	Bathroom/laundry shelf; keep away from food.
5	Personal Care	Comb, hair dye, deodorant, perfume, nail polish, grooming products.	Bathroom cabinet or personal-care box.
6	Medicines & First Aid	Eno, drops, syrup, alum, tablets, bandage, thermometer if available.	High, dry, labelled box away from children.
7	Tools & Repair	Screwdriver set, drill bits, tapes, cutter, glue gun, drill/grinder.	Utility shelf; heavy tools at bottom.
8	Electronics & Cables	Chargers, USB cables, adapters, earphones, extension board, power cords.	Dry box with cable ties and sub-labels.
9	Bags & Travel	Jute bags, backpacks, pouches, belts, wallets, travel items.	Lower shelf or wardrobe top.
10	Craft, Sewing & Decor	Thread, rope, craft sticks, artificial flowers, globe, decoration items.	Craft box or rare-use shelf.
11	Rare / Seasonal / Overflow	Extra, seasonal or unclear items waiting for final sorting.	Closed box at back or bottom shelf.

3. Box Size Guide

Choose transparent boxes with lids whenever possible. Transparent boxes reduce searching time, and lids keep dust away. For heavy tools, avoid very deep boxes; shallow boxes are easier and safer to lift.

Box Type	Approx. Size	Best For	Household Note
Small	25 x 18 x 10 cm	Pens, medicines, earphones, small chargers, clips.	Use when items are small and easy to lose.
Medium	35 x 25 x 15 cm	Spices, grooming items, small tools, cleaning cloths, craft items.	The most useful size for mixed household storage.
Large	45 x 35 x 25 cm	Documents, detergent, heavy tools, extension cords, overflow.	Keep only one category per box.
Extra Large	55 x 40 x 30 cm	Bags, folded cloth, travel items, bulky seasonal items.	Use sparingly; large boxes easily become dumping boxes.

Estimated requirement for the observed items

Box No.	Label Name	Size	Qty.	Purpose
B01	Daily Desk Items	Small	1	Pens, markers, eraser, stapler, scissors, ruler, keys and glasses.
B02	Documents & Books	Large flat	1	Loose papers, books, notebooks, receipts and documents.
B03-B04	Kitchen & Pantry	Medium	2	Spices in one box; cups, bowls and small containers in another.
B05	Cleaning & Laundry	Large	1	Detergent, fabric softener, handwash refill and cleaning liquids.
B06	Personal Care	Medium	1	Comb, hair dye, spray, perfume, nail polish and grooming products.
B07	Medicines & First Aid	Small	1	Medicines, Eno, drops, syrup, alum and small health items.
B08-B09	Tools & Repair	Large + Medium	2	Heavy tools in large box; tapes, cutters and small tools in medium box.
B10-B11	Electronics & Cables	Large + Small	2	Long wires in large box; chargers, adapters and earphones in small box.
B12	Bags & Travel	Extra large	1	Jute bags, backpacks, belts, pouches and travel accessories.
B13	Craft & Sewing	Medium	1	Threads, ropes, craft sticks, artificial flowers and hobby materials.
B14	Rare / Seasonal / Overflow	Large	1	Items not used monthly or items waiting for final decision.

Total: 14 boxes are enough for a clean standard arrangement. Keep 1 or 2 extra medium boxes if the household has many cables, cosmetics, craft materials or travel items.

4. Rack and Shelf Placement Plan

After sorting, place boxes according to reach and safety. The label should face outward. Heavy boxes should not be kept on high shelves.

Rack Level	Keep Here	Reason
Top / Eye Level	Daily Desk Items, Personal Care, Medicines & First Aid.	Quick reach; medicine should remain visible but away from children.
Middle Level	Documents & Books, Kitchen & Pantry, Cleaning Cloths, Small Tools.	Moderate-use items stay accessible without crowding the top shelf.
Lower Level	Heavy Tools, Detergent, Long Cables, Bags & Travel.	Heavy or bulky boxes are safer near the ground.
Back / Closed Area	Rare / Seasonal / Overflow, Decor, unused craft items.	Rare-use items should not disturb daily routines.

Recommended working sequence

- Empty one shelf at a time. Do not empty the whole house together.
- Make four piles: keep, shift to another room, donate/reuse, discard.
- Put each item into its purpose category. Do not create a mixed box unless it is labelled Miscellaneous / Overflow.
- Place a label on the front side of the box before putting it on the rack.
- Review the Rare / Overflow box once every month. Anything repeatedly unused should be reduced.

Tip for cable boxes: roll each wire separately and tie it with a rubber band, twist tie or small thread. Write the device name on a small paper tag if possible.

5. Customizable Item Arrangement

The following arrangement is based on the photographed items. A household can add or remove items according to need without changing the basic category system.

Category Label	Observed Items to Keep	Frequency
Daily Desk Items	Pens, pencils, markers, highlighter, eraser, stapler, scissors, ruler, keys, wallet, reading glasses.	Daily / frequent
Documents & Books	Books, notebooks, loose papers, receipts, documents and printed sheets.	Frequent to moderate
Kitchen & Pantry	Spice packets, kasoori methi, chicken masala, sambhar masala, meat masala, pickle/condiment jar, cups and bowls.	Frequent
Cleaning & Laundry	Detergent powder, fabric softener bottles, handwash dispenser, cleaning cloths, wipes and tissues.	Frequent to moderate
Personal Care	Comb, hair dye packet, deodorant/spray, perfume, hair oil, nail polish and grooming accessories.	Moderate
Medicines & First Aid	Eno, syrup/medicine bottles, eye/ear drops, alum and small health items.	As required
Tools & Repair	Screwdriver set, drill bits, hand drill, grinder/polishing tool, utility cutter, tapes and glue/clamp.	Moderate to rare
Electronics & Cables	Chargers, adapters, USB cables, green/black wires, earphones/headphones, extension board and small electronic parts.	Moderate
Bags & Travel	Jute/canvas bags, backpacks, cross-body bags, belts, pouches and travel accessories.	Moderate to rare
Craft, Sewing & Decor	Threads, ropes, craft sticks, artificial flowers, embroidery hoop, globe and decorative items.	Rare

6. One-Page Household Checklist

Print this page and tick each box while organizing.

Section	Checklist
Before buying boxes	☐ Remove broken, expired or empty items. ☐ Separate food, medicine, cleaning liquid and electronics. ☐ Count bulky items before buying extra-large boxes.
While filling boxes	☐ One box should have one main purpose. ☐ Daily items should not be packed under rare-use items. ☐ Medicines should be dry, labelled and out of children's reach. ☐ Cables should be rolled and tied separately. ☐ Heavy tools should be kept low, not above shoulder height.
After arranging the rack	☐ Every box label is visible from the front. ☐ There is one overflow box only, not many mixed boxes. ☐ Spices and food items are away from cleaning chemicals. ☐ Documents are in a dry, flat box. ☐ A review date is written on the overflow box.

Suggested household rule

If an item is used daily, it should be reachable in less than 10 seconds. If it is used monthly, it can be boxed. If it is not used for a year, it should be reviewed, donated, repaired or discarded.

Printable Label Sheet 1: Main Box Labels

12 labels per A4 page. Best for medium, large and extra-large boxes.

Daily Desk Items	Documents & Books	Kitchen & Pantry
Cleaning & Laundry	Personal Care	Medicines & First Aid
Tools & Repair	Electronics & Cables	Bags & Travel
Craft & Sewing	Decor & Seasonal	Miscellaneous / Overflow

Printable Label Sheet 2: Subcategory Labels

18 smaller labels per A4 page. Best for small boxes, trays and drawer dividers.

Pens & Markers	Stapler, Scissors & Ruler	Bills & Receipts
Spice Packets	Small Kitchen Items	Detergent & Fabric Care
Cleaning Cloths	Hair & Grooming	Health Items
Heavy Tools	Small Tools & Tapes	Chargers & Adapters
Earphones & Small Electronics	Long Wires	Bags & Belts
Sewing Items	Decorative Items	Extra Items

Printable Label Sheet 3: Blank Custom Labels

18 blank labels per A4 page. Write labels according to your own household items.

cut	Write label here	Write label here	Write label here	cut
	Write label here	Write label here	Write label here	
	Write label here	Write label here	Write label here	
	Write label here	Write label here	Write label here	
	Write label here	Write label here	Write label here	
	Write label here	Write label here	Write label here	
	Write label here	Write label here	Write label here	